

UNDERSTANDING

Semaglutide

Semaglutide is a modified molecule our bodies make, called a GLP-1 analog. It works by increasing insulin production and lowering glucagon secretion as well as targeting areas in the brain that regulate appetite and food intake. A small change in the molecule allows the drug to last weeks in our bodies rather than the natural version our bodies make, which lasts minutes.

Semaglutide has been shown to act in the following ways:

1. Delays how quickly our stomachs digest food, leading to a feeling of fullness and satisfaction with smaller meal sizes.
2. Slows intestinal motility so you will feel fuller longer after meals.
3. Lowers blood sugars, in part by reducing the production of sugar in the liver.
4. Stimulates insulin secretion by the pancreas.
5. Decreases inflammation throughout the body, which leads to adiponectin release and fat lipolysis.

POTENTIAL BENEFITS OF SEMAGLUTIDE

- * Decreased appetite and cravings
- * Weight loss
- * Improved blood glucose control
- * Decreased inflammation throughout the body

Semaglutide/Glycine/B12 Dosing 5/5/1 MG/ML

PRESCRIPTIONS	WEEKS	SUGGESTED PRESCRIBING FRAMEWORK
RX #1	1-4	0.5 mL vial = Inject 4 units (0.04 mL) subcutaneously weekly for 4 weeks.
RX #2	5-8	0.5 mL vial = Inject 8 units (0.08 mL) subcutaneously weekly for 4 weeks.
RX #3	9-12	1 mL vial = Inject 18 units (0.18 mL) subcutaneously weekly for 4 weeks.
RX #4	13-16	2 mL vial = Inject 30 units (0.3 mL) subcutaneously weekly for 4 weeks.
RX #5	16+	2 mL vial = Inject 44 units (0.44 mL) subcutaneously weekly for 4 weeks.

Suggested Prescribing Framework

RX #1	RX #2	RX #3	RX #4	RX #5
Semaglutide/Glycine/B12 5/5/1 mg/mL	Semaglutide/Glycine/B12 5/5/1 mg/mL	Semaglutide/Glycine/B12 5/5/1 mg/mL	Semaglutide/Glycine/B12 5/5/1 mg/mL	Semaglutide/Glycine/B12 5/5/1 mg/mL
Inject 4 units (0.04 mL) SC weekly for 4 weeks #0.5 mL vial	Inject 8 units (0.08 mL) SC weekly for 4 weeks #0.5 mL vial	Inject 18 units (0.18 mL) SC weekly for 4 weeks #1 mL vial	Inject 30 units (0.3 mL) SC weekly for 4 weeks #2 mL vial	Inject 44 units (0.44 mL) SC weekly for 4 weeks #2 mL vial / refills-3

*This is a dose titration example. Strive Pharmacy recommends using variable dose vials to achieve the lowest effective dose, even if it deviates from the dosing schedule. This helps to limit side effects and improve adherence.

Suggested Dosing Chart

SEMAGLUTIDE/ GLYCINE/B12 5/5/1 MG/ML	0.2 mg	0.4 mg	0.9 mg	1.5 mg	2.2 mg
	4 units (0.04 mL)	8 units (0.08 mL)	18 units (0.18 mL)	30 units (0.3 mL)	44 units (0.44 mL)

Side Effects/Contraindications:

The most common side effects include nausea and constipation. Patients also report acid reflux, stomach pain, vomiting, diarrhea, and injection site reactions. The risk of serious side effects increases in patients with hypoglycemia, kidney problems, and risk of allergic reactions.

* Cyanocobalamin 1 mg/mL added to help reduce the potential for nausea.

* Glycine 5 mg/mL added to help inhibit the deterioration of protein tissue that forms muscles. Studies show that administering glycine during calorie restriction may be beneficial for preserving muscle mass and loss of fat tissue.

WARNINGS

*This medication is **NOT** insulin and should not be used if you have type 1 diabetes **OR** if you develop diabetic ketoacidosis. Semaglutide should not be used with any other GLP-1 medications.

*Semaglutide can slow stomach emptying, which may cause complications with anesthesia or sedation. Inform healthcare providers before any planned surgery or procedure.

*Use with caution in patients with a history of diabetic retinopathy.

*Reports of suicidal thoughts or actions have been reported with use of this medication.

Risk of Thyroid C-Cell Tumors:

If you or any family members have been diagnosed with Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia Syndrome Type 2 (MEN 2) or Medullary Thyroid Cancer (MTC) you should not take semaglutide. If you have ever had pancreatitis consult with your medical provider as using semaglutide can increase the risk of developing pancreatitis.

Patient Pricing:

0.5 mL vial: \$125
1 mL vial: \$175
2 mL vial: \$225

Clinic Pricing:

0.5 mL vial: \$90
1 mL vial: \$140
2 mL vial: \$165